



PROGRESS REPORT

Eswatini: progress report, September 2025 – September 2026

Edition of 2026-09-01 · 108 systems and instruments tracked

GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY ·
INCLUSION · DATA · GEOPOLITICS · WHERE THE RECORD IS THIN

This report asks the same set of questions of every country. The rows below are a fixed frame of indicators, one row each, chosen in advance and covering all thirty-eight subjects the base tracks — so what appears here is decided by the frame and not by whichever records happened to accumulate. Each row says what happened on that indicator during the period, with every claim linked to the source it rests on.

Where a row reads *No evidence*, the base holds nothing on that indicator. **That is a statement about this base, not about the country** — it does not mean nothing exists, only that nothing has been collected here yet. The rows that carry evidence say what it is; the rows that do not are left to speak for themselves.

The period is 2025-09-01 to 2026-09-01.

Progress values. *Advanced* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a reported position worsened. *Mixed* — the indicator's instruments moved in different directions in the period; the clause after the comma names which moved which way. *No change* — the base holds a standing position and nothing in the period touched it. *No evidence* — the base holds nothing on this indicator at all. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Advanced, regulations still pending*.

Governance

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Strategies, plans and policies	Digital transformation strategy	A digital readiness assessment published in November 2024 places the country at the systematic stage across all six of its pillars. The assessment was launched by the ICT ministry with a development agency in November 2024 and places the country at the systematic stage across digital public infrastructure, connectivity, government, regulation, economy and people (assessment). It finds that a national digital strategy is in place but that digitalisation holds only moderate political support, naming limited political prioritisation and coordination as the constraint on the government pillar (finding). The strategy the assessment refers to is not itself held, and no implementation plan or budget against the assessment's recommendations is published.	ADVANCED
Strategies, plans and policies	ICT strategy		NO EVIDENCE
Strategies, plans and policies	Broadband strategy		NO EVIDENCE
Strategies, plans and policies	Data storage / cloud strategy		NO EVIDENCE
Strategies, plans and policies	Data interoperability framework / roadmap		NO EVIDENCE
Strategies, plans and policies	AI strategy	No national artificial-intelligence strategy or statute is held, and two instruments now carry artificial-intelligence rules while neither is an artificial-intelligence instrument. The finding is stated in coverage of the online media guidelines: rules on the technology are arriving inside instruments written for something else (absence). A national fourth-industrial-revolution strategy framed the prime minister's address to a global artificial-intelligence governance dialogue in Geneva (strategy), so the country argues a position internationally on the strength of an instrument that is not about artificial intelligence either.	NO CHANGE
Strategies, plans and policies	Data localisation policies		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Strategies, plans and policies	Data governance policy	A National Data Governance Policy is targeted for completion before end-2026, with government undecided between a standalone law and amendments to existing legislation. A first national workshop ran in April 2026 and the policy was validated in July, on a procurement issued through a continental alliance in 2025 (validation , workshop , procurement). The minister told the Senate the completion target and stated that government has not decided between a standalone data-governance law and amendments to what exists; the target was put as aspirational in debate rather than as a statutory deadline (senate). That undecided question matters more than the date: the country already has a data protection Act, so whether data governance sits inside it or beside it decides which authority enforces what.	ADVANCED
Strategies, plans and policies	Open data policy		NO EVIDENCE
Legislation and regulation	Data protection legislation	The Data Protection Act 2022 has been effective since March 2022, and its gazetted text names a Commission while the regulator describes itself as the designated Agency. The Act was gazetted and took effect on 4 March 2022. The mismatch between the body the statute names and the body describing itself as designated is recorded rather than resolved (Act). The Act is being read in press accounts as exposing online naming and shaming to a substantial penalty; that is an account of legal exposure rather than an enforcement action, and no complaint, ruling or authority statement is held (exposure). A statute whose enforcing body is ambiguous on the face of the record is a limit on everything the protection cells below can say.	NO CHANGE
Legislation and regulation	Cybersecurity legislation	Cybersecurity, critical infrastructure, e-commerce and artificial-intelligence legislation was named as forthcoming alongside the capital's smart-city deployment. Four instruments were named together in August 2025 (legislation). None has entered the base since as a draft, a tabling or an enactment. Naming a legislative programme alongside a deployment of 59 camera systems and a fifth-generation network is the sequence worth recording: the deployment is in progress and the four laws that would govern it are a list.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Legislation and regulation	Legislation covering digital id		NO EVIDENCE
Legislation and regulation	Digital payments legislation		NO EVIDENCE
Legislation and regulation	Legislation enabling data interoperability		NO EVIDENCE
Legislation and regulation	AI legislation / regulations		NO EVIDENCE
Legislation and regulation	E-commerce legislation	Online Media Publishing Guidelines 2026 are stated by the ministry as complete in development, and restrictions on children reaching harmful content were raised in the Senate with no instrument behind them. The ministry stated development of the guidelines is complete, and used the same account to state that implementation, enforcement and oversight of data protection are vested in the regulator rather than itself (guidelines). A senator asked during a Senate debate what prevents minors reaching harmful content; the answer was that two offices are working together on online-content regulation. No instrument, timetable, age-verification method or definition of harmful content is stated, and no draft is held (question). Guidelines complete but unpublished, and content regulation that exists only as an answer in debate, are the two forms this unit's regulation of platforms takes.	ADVANCED
Legislation and regulation	Statistics legislation		NO EVIDENCE
Legislation and regulation	Access to information legislation		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Data protection	Data protection authority	The authority opened its first major investigation, into a ministry that published unblurred national identity documents and missed the 72-hour breach-notification duty. The investigation was opened in June 2026, following an awareness campaign in February and a lender assessment naming digital transformation as key to growth (investigation , campaign , assessment). The breach was the ministry's own publication of unblurred identity documents, and it missed the statutory 72-hour notification (breach). The ICT ministry stated on the record that implementation, enforcement and oversight are vested in the regulator and not in itself, which settles the mandate question in practice even as the statute's naming of the body remains unresolved (mandate). A first investigation opening against a government ministry, rather than a private controller, is the strongest single fact about this authority in the record. The authority has used its powers: three enforcement notices under section 41 of the Act are published, two in June 2024 against a mobile operator and an insurer and one in March 2025 against the science and technology park . No register of complaints, breach notifications or registered controllers accompanies them.	ADVANCED
Data protection	National data protection readiness	Advisory guidelines on health data went to validation workshops, sector guidelines were validated over a week, and biometric gate passes were deployed in schools without ministry approval. Health-data guidelines opened validation workshops in July 2026 (health), and sector guidelines were validated at a week-long workshop in August; no breach count, penalty or enforcement action is published behind the regulator's ranking, and the draft guidelines are not held (sector). Some public schools deployed biometric gate passes without education ministry approval, charging about E200 per pupil (schools). Guidelines being validated at sector level while individual schools are already collecting children's biometrics for a fee, unapproved, is the gap between the regime being written and the practice on the ground.	ADVANCED
Regional collaboration	Regional policy collaboration		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Regional collaboration	Regional legal harmonisation		NO EVIDENCE
Regional collaboration	Shared regional infrastructure		NO EVIDENCE
Regional collaboration	Cross-border data transfers	Regional transfers are permitted under conditions by the Data Protection Act, while a United States bilateral health agreement has data-sharing terms that remain unpublished. The Act permits transfers within the regional bloc under conditions, which is an adequacy model written into the statute (bloc). The health memorandum was announced in August 2026. A federal complaint records that the State Department entered into dozens of such bilateral agreements between December 2025 and February 2026, each typically a memorandum plus at least one further data-sharing agreement, that a freedom-of-information request of December 2025 covers this country's agreements, and that the department published a subset of the memoranda in March 2026 and then withdrew public access. The data-sharing terms remain unpublished (agreement). So the statute governs regional transfers on published conditions and the largest bilateral transfer arrangement runs on terms nobody outside the parties can read. A regional federated know-your-customer layer is being funded: technical assistance was announced in August 2025 to connect national digital identity systems across 16 member states over the existing regional settlement and immediate-clearing payment systems (framework). The announcement is the implementing partners' rather than the regional secretariat's, and names no Eswatini commitment, date or instrument.	ADVANCED
Standards	National interoperability standards		NO EVIDENCE
Standards	National quality standards		NO EVIDENCE
Standards	Adoption of international standards		NO EVIDENCE
Public debate and participation in policymaking	Non-governmental contribution to national policy		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Public debate and participation in policymaking	Open discussion of government policy	The prime minister first dismissed a memorandum with a hyperscaler, then acknowledged in writing that Cabinet had approved it. A former minister defended the memorandum publicly and the attorney-general confirmed that Cabinet and legal consultation preceded signature (defence , account). The published analysis argues the memorandum was not the real problem. What the exchange establishes for this frame is narrower and sufficient: a head of government publicly denied and then confirmed the existence of an approved instrument, in writing, and that correction happened because the question was pressed in public.	ADVANCED

Finance

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Domestic budget appropriations and expenditure	Sustainable domestic financing of digital transformation	The tax gap stands at E4.4 billion, and the largest digital programme in the country runs on E1.2 billion of external money. The revenue commissioner general put the tax gap at E4.4 billion in October 2025, with wholesale and retail the largest contributor, chiefly in value added tax . The digital transformation programme carries E1.2 billion, about US\$65 million, of which E648 million goes to affordable broadband and E450 million to the citizen-services component , and it is externally financed rather than appropriated. No domestic budget appropriation for digital transformation is held for any year, which is what leaves the programme's continuation resting on the external facility.	REGRESSED
MoUs and other agreements	Strategic relationships	Digital transformation was named a priority area at a leaders' meeting with a bilateral partner in Taipei. The meeting's own date is not established and the report is dated August 2026 (meeting). No memorandum, workstream, value or timetable is named. Against a unit whose forward programme rests on one lender operation and one hyperscaler memorandum, a named priority area at a leaders' meeting is the whole of this bilateral relationship on the digital record.	ADVANCED
New investments	Mobilisation of non-state finance		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
New investments	Development-partner project financing	More than E1.06bn of lender financing was approved for a digital project, reported at US\$65m, after the opportunity was noted as absent from the prime minister year-end statement. The financing was approved in mid-2026 and converted in the source at E16.37 to the dollar; the ministry's own quarterly report behind it is not held (financing , appraisal , project). A commentary in January 2026 noted the digital-transformation opportunity as omitted from the prime minister's 2025 year-end statement (omission). The project is the vehicle for the electronic identity, the public-institution connectivity target, the short-code service access and the change-agent training recorded separately — so one operation carries most of the forward programme.	ADVANCED

ICT Infrastructure

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Connectivity	Mobile penetration	Mobile coverage against mobile-internet use has not moved, while a smart-city deployment fits a fifth-generation network, 59 camera systems and public wireless access in the capital. The coverage and usage figures come from the ICT ministry, given at a change-management workshop for the digital project (coverage , reform). The capital's deployment fits a fifth-generation network, 59 artificial-intelligence-enabled cameras and public wireless access (deployment). No lawful basis, retention rule or oversight arrangement for the camera network is stated anywhere, and the four laws named as forthcoming alongside it — including critical infrastructure and artificial intelligence — have not appeared.	NO CHANGE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Connectivity	Internet usage	The regulator proposed raising the minimum service standard from 2 Mbps to 10 Mbps, and free statutory complaint adjudication runs on windows of one to six months by sector. The proposal was issued as a public notice in July 2026 (proposal). Adjudication is free under the 2013 communications Act, with windows of one month for post and courier, three for broadcasting and six for telecommunications; these are structural provisions of the Act rather than dated state (adjudication). A six-month window for a telecommunications complaint is long enough that the remedy is unlikely to reach the problem it was raised about, and no complaint volume or outcome series is published.	ADVANCED
Connectivity	Mobile affordability	The cost of data as a share of income per head sits above the international affordability threshold. The finding is stated in an August 2025 account and nothing has moved it since (affordability). It is the constraint under the usage gap recorded separately — mobile coverage substantially exceeds mobile-internet use — and no tariff instrument, subsidy or device-financing scheme appears anywhere in this ledger to address it.	NO CHANGE
Connectivity	National fibre backbone	International capacity rose from 47 to 72 Gbps, above target, and 1,031 public institutions are targeted for connection under the digital project. The capacity increase was reported in February 2026 as above target (capacity , rollout). The institution target was stated at the project's change-management workshop (institutions). A landlocked country raising international capacity by half in a reporting period is a real gain; it is also why the satellite gateway recorded separately is framed as reducing dependence on cross-border fibre.	ADVANCED
Connectivity	International internet bandwidth		NO EVIDENCE
Connectivity	Internet Exchange Points		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Connectivity	Satellite broadband licensing and availability	A government satellite gateway was commissioned to reach mountainous and remote areas and reduce dependence on cross-border fibre, and a business reseller channel launched as a joint venture. The gateway was commissioned in April 2026, its stated purpose reaching mountainous and remote areas and reducing dependence on cross-border fibre (gateway). A joint venture launched as an authorised business reseller in July 2025 (reseller). A government-commissioned gateway is an unusual arrangement — most units in this frame record licensing and resale rather than state operation — and no capacity, coverage or cost figure is published for it.	ADVANCED
Data Storage	Local data centre capacity (all providers)	A government assessment finds ministries depend heavily on the National Data Centre with no internal fallback. The assessment finding is that dependence is heavy and internal fallback absent (assessment , centre). No capacity, tenancy, availability or redundancy figure is published for the facility itself. A single national facility with no ministry-level fallback is a concentration risk the state's own assessment names and nothing on record answers.	NO CHANGE
Data Storage	Local data centre capacity (national providers)		NO EVIDENCE
Data Storage	Off-site backup capacity		NO EVIDENCE
Energy	Sufficient energy and water for data centres	The ICT minister met a Gulf clean-energy firm to discuss dedicated supply for the National Data Centre, and nothing has been signed. The meeting took place at an international government summit in February 2026 and nothing was signed (supply , discussions). Dedicated power for the single national facility on which ministries have no fallback is the right problem to be working on. That it is at the stage of an unsigned discussion is the state of it. The published tariff schedule is where this can be tested, and it does not carry the category: an average increase of 13.61 per cent was approved for 2026/27 and revised down to 11.74 per cent after special government funding, effective 1 April 2026 , across a lifeline domestic band and time-of-use commercial tariffs, with no data-centre or large-load category anywhere in it.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Energy	Grid reliability		NO EVIDENCE
Energy	Rural electrification		NO EVIDENCE
Technical Capacity	Robustness of government hardware and software	A Digital Landscape Assessment found ministry data backup and ICT maintenance wanting and government systems not interoperable, with critical state information at risk in nine ministries. The assessment was received and endorsed by the ICT ministry, so the finding is the government's own rather than an outside audit (backups). Interoperability between government systems is a finding of the same assessment (interoperability). A state that has endorsed an assessment saying critical information is at risk in nine ministries, while running everything on one data centre with no ministry-level fallback, has documented its own exposure. The assessment is also what the electronic-government strategy is being founded on, which is the right response and has not yet produced a strategy.	REGRESSED
Technical Capacity	Local capacity to maintain, manage and develop government systems		NO EVIDENCE
Cybersecurity	National cybersecurity readiness	A regional cybersecurity framework was finalised and approved at a subcommittee hosted in-country, and a national awareness month was opened by the prime minister. The regional framework was finalised and approved by a central bank governors' subcommittee at a meeting in the country in July 2026 (framework). Cybersecurity awareness month was opened by the prime minister in October 2025 (awareness). Neither is a national instrument. The country has no cybersecurity statute — one was named as forthcoming a year ago — no incident response team on record, and no incident, caseload or capability figure anywhere in this ledger. Enforcement has a unit behind it: a police digital forensic unit and cyber task team had made 87 arrests and submitted 528 dockets to the prosecutions director by October 2025 , working on mobile money fraud, fake wallet schemes, online loan scams and rental scams. Over E8.5 million was involved in cyber-related crime in the twelve months to 30 September 2025 .	ADVANCED

DPI

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Data Exchange	National data exchange system		NO EVIDENCE
Data Exchange	Use of digital id in other systems		NO EVIDENCE
Data Exchange	Interoperability of health systems	A master patient index integrated with the population registry now feeds a standards-based health information exchange across previously disconnected systems. An implementing partner deployed a master patient index using deterministic and probabilistic matching with machine-learning enhancement, integrated the population registry to strengthen patient identification, and added fuzzy search for name variations (index). A second phase put the index behind an interoperability platform and configured a health-data-standard exchange, with separate mediators for demographic and clinical data and end-to-end testing on real workflows (exchange). The account is the implementing partner's rather than the ministry's, and no statement of which facilities are connected, what volume is exchanged, or under what legal basis patient data moves between them, is held.	ADVANCED
Data Exchange	Interoperability of education systems		NO EVIDENCE
Data Exchange	Interoperability of social protection systems		NO EVIDENCE
Digital Identity and CRVS	Robustness of system	Electronic identities are planned under the digital project for a 2027 rollout, and national card production resumed in February 2026 after a suspension from late September 2025. Electronic identities are planned for a 2027 rollout, on a readiness report first published in 2024 (plan , readiness). Production of the existing national card was suspended in late September 2025 and resumed on 22 February 2026; the card is not a digital identity (resumption , regulation). No cause, backlog figure or remediation is published for the five-month suspension. A credential system that stopped issuing for five months, in the same period its ministry published unblurred identity documents and missed the breach-notification duty, is the base on which the 2027 electronic identity is to be built.	MIXED electronic identity planned for 2027 while national card production was suspended for five months

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Identity and CRVS	Registration of entire population		NO EVIDENCE
Digital Identity and CRVS	National maintenance of id and credentials systems		NO EVIDENCE
Digital Identity and CRVS	Authentication	The central bank is standing up a national electronic know-your-customer registry to digitise identity verification. The registry was reported in September 2025 (registry). No go-live, participant count or governing instrument is published. It would be the country's first authentication layer, and it is being built by the central bank rather than by the identity or ICT authorities – so the first working identity verification in the state may sit inside the financial regulator.	ADVANCED
Digital Identity and CRVS	Digital id from birth		NO EVIDENCE
Digital Identity and CRVS	Interoperability of birth registration and digital id		NO EVIDENCE
Digital Identity and CRVS	Use by other systems		NO EVIDENCE
Digital Payments and Fintech	Governance role of central bank	A National FinTech Strategy 2025-2030 was launched by the central bank governor and the finance minister, above a digital currency design paper published in 2024. The strategy was launched in December 2025, framed around reducing reliance on cash (strategy , cash). The design paper is not an issuance decision, and no pilot, launch date or governance arrangement follows it (paper). The central bank's annual integrated reports are held for two successive years, the later superseding a payment-switch participation series the base had carried from earlier reporting (report , prior). The settlement layer under all of it is old and undocumented since: the interbank payment and settlement system runs under a rulebook adopted by its steering committee in May 2007 (rulebook), and the central bank describes its role as facilitating development and overseeing the safety and soundness of national payment systems (mandate). No revision of the rulebook, and no volume or value statistic for the system, is published.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Payments and Fintech	G2P functionality		NO EVIDENCE
Digital Payments and Fintech	Revenue collection		NO EVIDENCE
Digital Payments and Fintech	B2B and B2G functionality		NO EVIDENCE
Digital Payments and Fintech	P2P, P2G and P2B functionality	The payment switch launched fast payments as phase one of three, and 35 post offices opened for government-service payments. Fast payments launched as phase one of three; no source held confirms whether the remaining five participants went live as expected by end-January 2025 (launch , explainer). Thirty-five post offices were opened for government-service payments in September 2025 (post offices). A rail whose participant list cannot be confirmed eighteen months after phase one, alongside a physical over-the-counter channel, is where person-to-government payment actually stands here.	ADVANCED
Digital Payments and Fintech	Population uptake	Account ownership rose on a global survey cited in the record, against a cash share of person-to-business payments the lender assessed as high. The account ownership figure is a reference-study figure, cited rather than absorbed (ownership), and the cash share comes from a lender assessment of digital public infrastructure (cash). The mobile money platform migrated to a cloud-native vendor platform across four markets; the performance figures are the vendor's own and no downtime, cost or subscriber-impact figure is stated (migration). Neither uptake figure is a domestic series, so what the payment switch and the post-office channel changed cannot be measured from this base.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Payments and Fintech	Cross-border functionality	Migration of regional low-value flows to a bloc settlement system is reported under way with no timetable, and accession to a continental payment system was discussed with a bilateral partner. The migration is reported as under way with no timetable, volume, value or mandating instrument given (migration). The central bank governor discussed leveraging another country's experience to accelerate continental accession (accession). Both are cross-border commitments stated in the same bilateral meeting account, and neither has a date.	ADVANCED
Digital Payments and Fintech	Consumer protection	A finance portfolio committee tabled a report on bank transaction charges and recommended the central bank report a comparative benchmark within 30 days of adoption. The report was tabled in July 2026 (report) with a recommendation that the central bank produce a comparative benchmark of charges within 30 days of adoption (benchmark). No adoption date, benchmark or central bank response is on record. Legislative scrutiny of transaction pricing is rare in this frame and worth recording as such; whether it produced anything is unestablished.	ADVANCED
Registries	Population register	A compulsory civil register has run since January 1984 under a 1983 statute, and nothing in the base shows it has been digitised. The register commenced on 6 January 1984 under a births, marriages and deaths registration Act, administered by a registrar in the home affairs ministry (statute , assessment). It is a paper-based statute and nothing shows digitisation. The electronic identity planned for 2027 would therefore be built on a register whose current form is unrecorded, in the ministry whose card production stopped for five months and which is under investigation for a data breach.	NO CHANGE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Registries	Civil register	A proposed DNA requirement for birth certificates is costed at about E126m a year, roughly 46 per cent of the home affairs budget. The costing is reported against the ministry's budget (proposal). It is a proposal only. Requiring genetic testing to register a birth would be the most invasive civil-registration rule in this frame, and the account that reaches the base is about its cost rather than its lawful basis, consent model or effect on registration rates. The improvement work has a structure behind it: a national steering committee and technical working group were established under a continental mentorship programme whose second phase launched in February 2022 (programme), with a university partner supporting the government since 2015 on foreign health-programme funding (support). Over 10,000 of the births occurring in 2021 were registered late .	ADVANCED
Registries	Address register		NO EVIDENCE
Registries	Business register	Company name search and reservation run online with incorporation in a day, and a one-stop shop for investors opened in July 2025. Name availability is searched and reserved through the government portal, the reservation holding for 90 days, and incorporation is processed within one day; fees run from E645 to E1,845 by nominal capital (procedure). The one-stop shop opened to the public on 21 July 2025 after a pilot from May, offering a trading licence, a taxpayer identification number, home affairs permits and science park services from one counter to investors turning over E2 million or more, or E10 million for foreign investors (shop). Only one-month work permits can be applied for through it; longer permits still go to the home affairs ministry (limit). No register size or transaction count is published.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Registries	Social protection register	A social registry is piloting in one of four regions, with 44,683 households enrolled and targeting run on a proxy means test. The Shiselweni pilot covered 47,766 households, registered 44,683 of them and recorded 3,088 as vacant or non-consenting , against a projected 47,260 households in the region. Targeting uses a proxy means test built on 20 variables from the household income and expenditure survey, and the programme carries US\$2.5 million, about E42.5 million, of World Bank funding ; each region is to be given three months to implement. No national rollout date, no statement of which grant programmes will draw on the registry, and no data-protection or grievance arrangement for it, are on record.	ADVANCED
Registries	Electoral register		NO EVIDENCE
Registries	Tax register	Taxpayer identification number registration is free but paper-based, on a form collected from an office or downloaded, with twelve supporting documents. The procedure is free and administered by the revenue service under the value added tax statute, with the form collected from an office or downloaded and twelve supporting documents required, from a certified certificate of incorporation to evidence of a fixed place of business and the capacity to keep accounting records (procedure). There is no online submission route, which sits against company registration in the same ministry running through the government portal (company). No count of registered taxpayers is published, and the underlying forms the procedure page links carry dates of April 2020.	NO CHANGE
Registries	Land register	The deeds registry is still manual, with the registrar stating an intention to move to a fully electronic system after two study missions in five months. A delegation from the deeds registry and the science and technology park made a five-day study visit to a neighbouring land registry in August 2025, the second such mission in five months, the first having been led by the principal secretary for natural resources and energy (mission). The registrar stated that registration and storage of deeds remain manual and that the country is working to upgrade them into a fully electronic system (position). No system, procurement, budget line or date for that upgrade is on record, and no parcel or title count is published.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Sectoral management information systems	Health	Community health services moved from paper to digital records, and a regional artificial-intelligence health partnership was signed in-country with a private firm. The transition from paper to digital records in community health services is documented in February 2026 (transition). A memorandum between a regional health body and a private firm to scale artificial-intelligence health solutions was signed in the country in August 2026 (partnership). Advisory guidelines on processing personal health data were still in validation workshops at that point, so the partnership and the digitisation are both ahead of the guidance meant to govern them. Underneath the policy the record system is in place: an open-source, government-owned electronic medical record is live at 233 sites, 73 per cent of health facilities , keyed on a unique identity number with role-based access and backed up in government-owned cloud systems, so a patient's history follows them between districts.	ADVANCED
Sectoral management information systems	Education	A school education management information system went national in March 2024, carrying individual learner and staff records keyed to a personal identification number. The system was launched nationally between 19 and 22 March 2024 , after a pilot begun in 2020 and testing in ten schools. It replaces semi-annual paper returns entered centrally into a desktop database, carries both aggregate education data and individual learner and staff records identified by a personal identification number, and was built on an open-source platform by the education ministry with a UN agency, a university and two implementing partners (implementation). Unreliable internet, a shortage of school-owned devices and limited digital skills leave most rural primary schools collecting enrolment, attendance and learner data on paper for later entry (constraints). No enrolment count or data-sharing arrangement with the population register is published.	ADVANCED
Sectoral management information systems	Social protection		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Sectoral management information systems	Justice	An integrated electronic case management system launched in August 2025 is being extended across the justice sector, with no live-service statement yet. The system was launched by the justice ministry on 18 August 2025, beginning end-user capacity building across the sector (system). It is designed to replace paper filing with electronic case filing, virtual hearings and case tracking, and to connect the judiciary, the justice ministry, the law society, the police, the anti-corruption commission and correctional services on one platform; a development agency donated the equipment (design). Parliamentary portfolio committees were briefed on 20 May 2026, where the senate president raised the security of court files in the system (briefing). No case volume, court coverage or go-live date is published.	ADVANCED
Sectoral management information systems	Tax	Online filing has been compulsory since 2022, and the revenue service is procuring fiscalisation and electronic invoicing to close an E4.4 billion tax gap. Online filing was made compulsory for income tax payers with a zero-cash-handling payment policy; an independent evaluation found registered taxpayers 60 per cent less likely to file nil returns and 70 per cent more likely to pay once they had filed (mandate). The tax gap stands at E4.4 billion, with wholesale and retail the largest contributor, chiefly in value added tax , and the compliance improvement plan segments taxpayers four ways and names analytics and fiscalisation as the detection method. A fiscalisation and electronic invoicing system went to the market in May 2025, specified for real-time invoice reporting, fiscal devices integrated with revenue systems and predictive targeting of high-risk taxpayers; no award, supplier or value is on record (procurement).	ADVANCED
Sectoral management information systems	Customs		NO EVIDENCE
Sectoral management information systems	Land		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Other GovTech and e-Gov	e-government services	A citizen application and a tax application launched together, and the prime minister told the House that a memorandum signed without proper consideration for data protection is meaningless. Both applications launched in May 2025, for government services and for tax accounts and clearance certificates (launch , applications). The prime minister's own words — that the application must be watertight, that his office does not support outsourcing data to global technology companies, and that a memorandum signed without proper consideration for data protection is meaningless — are in his written responses tabled to the House of Assembly in March 2026 (responses , criticism). An assessment count of government services available online is held (services), and an electronic-government strategy is being founded on that same assessment with nothing yet produced (strategy).	MIXED two citizen applications live while the prime minister states a memorandum signed without proper data-protection consideration is meaningless

Digitalisation

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digitalisation of sub-national government	ICT infrastructure for local government	Thirty-eight constituency centres are included in the digital project's connectivity target. The centres are part of the 1,031-institution target (centres). No timetable, service list or per-centre arrangement is published. Constituency centres are the tier at which most citizens meet the state in this country, so their inclusion in the connectivity target is the single most consequential line in it.	ADVANCED
Digitalisation of sub-national government	Digitalisation of local government records		NO EVIDENCE
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural health clinics		NO EVIDENCE
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural primary schools		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural registry offices	Short-code access to public services is planned so citizens without smartphones can transact, and 44 devices were handed to agricultural extension officers. Short-code access is planned under the digital project specifically so citizens without smartphones can transact (access). In a country where data cost sits above the affordability threshold, that is the design choice that decides whether the rest of the programme reaches anyone rural. Forty-four devices were handed to extension officers in August 2026, with no officer total, data platform, reporting standard or custodian for the collected field data stated (devices). Field data collected on state-issued devices with no named custodian is a data-protection question the guidelines under validation do not yet reach.	ADVANCED
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural police stations		NO EVIDENCE

Technology

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
AI	Use of AI in government administration	The Auditor-General launched a 2026-2030 strategic plan integrating artificial intelligence, and the plan text is not held. The plan was launched in August 2026 (plan , integration). No tool, data access, assurance standard or safeguard for audit use of artificial intelligence is stated. A supreme audit institution adopting the technology is consequential — it is the body that would otherwise audit its use elsewhere in government — and the country has no artificial-intelligence strategy or statute at all.	ADVANCED
AI	Use of AI in sectoral management information systems	Three platforms were launched with an operator covering agriculture, health and the creative economy. The three platforms launched together in June 2026 (platforms). No user count, data arrangement, custodian or public-sector role is published for any of them. Three sectoral platforms delivered through a commercial operator, in a country whose government systems its own assessment finds not interoperable, is a delivery route that works and does not connect to anything.	ADVANCED
AI	Development of national / regional AI systems		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
AI	Control of AI abuse	The regulator urged broadcasters to manage artificial intelligence and deepfakes ethically and transparently. The guidance was issued in November 2025 (guidance). It is guidance to a single sector, urging rather than requiring, and it is one of the two instruments that carry artificial-intelligence rules in a country with no artificial-intelligence instrument. The other is the online media guidelines.	ADVANCED
ICT Industry	National capacity in DT-related production	A provisional banking licence was granted for a transition to a full digital bank. The provisional licence was granted and the transition is under way (licence). No capital, timetable, customer base or launch date is published. It is the only domestic digital-industry item in this ledger apart from platforms delivered by a mobile operator.	ADVANCED
Innovation ecosystem	Technology hubs		NO EVIDENCE
Innovation ecosystem	Tech startup ecosystem		NO EVIDENCE

Capacity

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Literacy	Digital literacy (civil service)		NO EVIDENCE
Literacy	Digital literacy (general population)	The ICT minister set a target for digitally skilled citizens, and a domestic practitioner published guidance on digital workplace transformation. The target was set in February 2026 (target) and no programme, budget or measurement method is attached to it. A book by a domestic ICT practitioner is the only other literacy item in the ledger (book). A national skills target with no delivery instrument behind it, in a country whose stated internet-usage and youth-unemployment rates are recorded elsewhere in this report, is an aspiration rather than a programme.	ADVANCED
Training and skills	DT-related training in secondary education		NO EVIDENCE
Training and skills	DT-related university facilities and qualifications		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Training and skills	Graduates entering DT ecosystem	Artificial-intelligence, robotics and cybersecurity training was announced as the next phase at innovation hubs, and cross-ministry change agents are in training for the 2027 rollout. The hub curriculum was announced at a hub handover as the phase beyond basic digital literacy (curriculum). Change agents across ministries are in training for the digital project's 2027 rollout (agents). Neither carries a cohort size, curriculum, completion measure or placement figure. Training change agents ahead of a rollout is the correct order, and it is the only training in this unit tied to a specific delivery date.	ADVANCED
Research institutions	Think tanks and academic departments contributing to DT policy	A university computer science department names a health-informatics research group and a cybersecurity and forensics group alongside a masters programme. The department runs undergraduate and masters programmes in computer science, information technology and information science, and lists two research groups, one in health informatics and one in cybersecurity and forensics, with pages for publications and conferences and for research grants (department). It also hosts an ICT fair, a deep learning event and a hackathon, and acknowledges a development agency for sponsoring student data during remote teaching (activity). No funding line, output count or contribution to national digital policy is stated for either group, so what the department contributes to policy is not established.	NO CHANGE

Inclusion

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Access to services	Citizen feedback portals		NO EVIDENCE
Access to services	Citizen participation in policy		NO EVIDENCE
Access to services	Gender equity		NO EVIDENCE
Access to services	Inclusion of persons with disabilities		NO EVIDENCE
Access to services	Inclusion of refugees and IDPs		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital divides	Bridging of digital divides	A second community innovation hub opened in August 2026, against a stated 58 per cent internet-usage rate and 56 per cent youth unemployment. The second hub opened in a rural region (hub , phase). It opened against a stated 58 per cent internet-usage rate and 56 per cent youth unemployment, and the account is the funding agency's own (opening). No financing figure was disclosed for the facility, and no user, training or enterprise-support count is published for either hub (hubs). Two hubs are the country's whole physical inclusion programme.	ADVANCED

Data

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
National statistics	National strategy for development of statistics		NO EVIDENCE
National statistics	Censuses and surveys	A consumer financial survey launched its 2026 round, replacing a 2018 measurement, and a communications sector study was tendered at about E2.8m. The survey round was launched in July 2026, replacing a measurement eight years old (survey). The sector study tender was awarded in January 2026 (study). Both are commissioned measurements rather than recurring statistical series, and both are being stood up to replace figures the country has been reading from foreign reference studies — which is what the account-ownership and cash-share cells in this report rest on.	ADVANCED
National statistics	Statistics from administrative data		NO EVIDENCE
Open data	Use of open data		NO EVIDENCE
Use of satellite data	Agricultural use of satellite data		NO EVIDENCE
Use of satellite data	Meteorological use of satellite data		NO EVIDENCE

Geopolitics

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
US / hyperscaler activities	USA / hyperscaler MoUs, engagements and commitments	A hyperscaler memorandum was confirmed by the attorney-general to have followed Cabinet and legal consultation, and a specimen sharing agreement entered into force in January 2026. The attorney-general confirmed that Cabinet approval and legal consultation preceded signature (confirmation , partnership), and the country was represented at the vendor's continental summit with its citizen application showcased (summit , partners). The specimen sharing agreement was signed in December 2025 and entered into force on 11 January 2026. The memorandum it hangs on is not published: main texts were posted for several countries and removed, and for this country only the agreement remains posted (agreement). So the hyperscaler arrangement was contested in public and its approval route confirmed, while the health arrangement's governing memorandum was published and then withdrawn.	ADVANCED
China activities	Chinese MoUs, engagements and commitments		NO EVIDENCE
EU activities	EU MoUs, engagements and commitments		NO EVIDENCE
Gulf/UAE activities	Gulf MoUs, engagements and commitments	A women digital academy was launched virtually under a bilateral memorandum signed at a United Nations General Assembly. The academy launched in July 2026 under a memorandum signed at the 2025 General Assembly (academy). No cohort size, curriculum, funding or duration is published. It is the only delivered output of any Gulf arrangement in this ledger; the other, on power for the national data centre, remains an unsigned discussion.	ADVANCED
India activities	India MoUs, engagements and commitments		NO EVIDENCE

Where the record is thin

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
Compute or high-performance computing capacity	A capacity disclosure for the National Data Centre - rack count, megawatts, uptime tier or utilisation - or a separate compute facility specification.	2026-08-09
Open government data portal	A national open-data portal, the published National Data Governance Policy text, or an access-to-information instrument.	2026-08-09
European Union digital cooperation with Eswatini	A named EU or European Investment Bank instrument, financing or programme covering Eswatini digital work.	2026-08-09

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
National AI strategy	A national AI strategy or statute, or a ministerial statement giving its drafting stage and expected adoption date.	2026-08-09
Chinese digital investment in Eswatini	Any Chinese financing, contract or memorandum covering Eswatini digital infrastructure.	2026-08-09
Indian digital cooperation with Eswatini	The India Exim Bank line-of-credit agreement or a programme document describing what it funds.	2026-08-09
Domestic budget appropriation for digital transformation	The estimates of expenditure or appropriation act showing lines for the ICT ministry, ESCCOM or the Royal Science and Technology Park.	2026-08-09
United States bilateral health agreement and its data-sharing agreement	The memorandum of understanding and the related data-sharing agreement themselves, a signature date, or an Eswatini government statement naming the instrument. The text is withheld rather than unpublished, and is in litigation in the United States District Court for the District of Columbia	not yet probed

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This is a dated edition and is not revised after publication. If a figure here has moved, the current edition will say so.